



ENGINEERING ACCREDITATION COMMISSION

**THE UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS AT
CHICAGO**

CHICAGO, IL, UNITED STATES

FINAL STATEMENT OF ACCREDITATION
2020-21 ACCREDITATION CYCLE

THE UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS AT CHICAGO

Chicago, IL, United States

ABET ENGINEERING ACCREDITATION COMMISSION

FINAL STATEMENT

VISIT DATES: OCTOBER 18-20, 2020

ACCREDITATION CYCLE CRITERIA: 2020-2021

INTRODUCTION & DISCUSSION OF STATEMENT CONSTRUCT

The Engineering Accreditation Commission (EAC) of ABET has evaluated the Bioengineering (Bachelor of Science), Chemical Engineering (Bachelor of Science), Civil Engineering (Bachelor of Science), Computer Engineering (Bachelor of Science), Electrical Engineering (Bachelor of Science), Engineering Physics (Bachelor of Science), Industrial Engineering (Bachelor of Science), and Mechanical Engineering (Bachelor of Science) programs at the University of Illinois at Chicago.

The statement that follows consists of two parts: the first addresses the institution and its overall educational unit, and the second addresses the individual programs.

A program's accreditation action is based upon the findings summarized in this statement. Actions depend on the program's range of compliance or non-compliance with the criteria. This range can be construed from the following terminology:

- **Deficiency** A deficiency indicates that a criterion, policy, or procedure is not satisfied. Therefore, the program is not in compliance with the criterion, policy, or procedure.
- **Weakness** A weakness indicates that a program lacks the strength of compliance with a criterion, policy, or procedure to ensure that the quality of the program will not be compromised. Therefore, remedial action is required to strengthen compliance with the criterion, policy, or procedure prior to the next review.
- **Concern** A concern indicates that a program currently satisfies a criterion, policy, or procedure; however, the potential exists for the situation to change such that the criterion, policy, or procedure may not be satisfied.
- **Observation** An observation is a comment or suggestion that does not relate directly to the current accreditation action but is offered to assist the institution in its continuing efforts to improve its programs.

INFORMATION RECEIVED AFTER THE REVIEW

- **Seven-Day Response** No information was received in the seven-day response period.
- **30-Day Due-Process Response** Information was received in the 30-day due-process response

period relative to the Computer Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Engineering Physics, Industrial Engineering, and Mechanical Engineering programs.

- **Post-30-Day Due-Process Response** Information was received in the post-30-day due-process response period relative to the Electrical Engineering program.

INSTITUTIONAL SUMMARY

One of 12 public, four-year universities in the State of Illinois, the University of Illinois at Chicago (UIC) is a public urban-serving university that was established in 1965. The university's 16 colleges enroll 21,921 undergraduates and 11,597 graduate students. UIC employs 2,817 full-time faculty and 6,021 academic and civil servants to administer 86 bachelors, 111 masters, 66 doctoral and 66 certificate programs. The College of Engineering (COE) offers 10 undergraduate and 20 graduate programs in six departments. In the college there are 141 tenured and tenure-track faculty and 64 term faculty who specifically support the teaching and research missions. The enrollments in 2019-20 across engineering programs consist of 4,174 undergraduates, 652 masters and 571 doctoral students. The COE produced 556 graduates in the 2019-20 academic year.

The following units were reviewed and found to adequately support the engineering programs: biology, chemistry, mathematics, physics, and the environmental health and safety office (EHS).

INSTITUTIONAL STRENGTHS

1. The College of Engineering has an engineering advisory board which captures the essence of innovation and entrepreneurship. Board membership includes only individuals who sit in positions of executive leadership. More than 45 board members provide strategic vision, opportunities for internships and shadowing, and professional engagement for all students. This unique board, many of whose members are UIC graduates, provides insight for student's upward mobility and professional achievement.
2. UIC is a beacon of opportunity for its urban population. Sixty percent of incoming freshmen and 35 percent of its transfer population receive PELL awards. The Guaranteed Paid Internship Program (GPIP) established by the College of Engineering is an innovative and unique opportunity for freshman engineering students to serve as paid interns during their first summer. The GPIP supplements other internship opportunities open to engineering students, giving them a greater chance to experience real-world engineering early in their undergraduate careers. Opportunities such as the GPIP contribute to the recruitment and retention of students of limited financial means, including those who are first-generation college students. Through guaranteed internships, research experiences, and design experiences students are provided the same educational opportunities afforded at elite research universities, thus fostering their professional and academic success.

Chemical Engineering

Bachelor of Science Program

Evaluated under EAC Program Criteria for
Chemical, Biochemical, Biomolecular and Similarly Named Engineering Programs

INTRODUCTION

The Chemical Engineering (Bachelor of Science) program is housed within the Department of Chemical Engineering and is offered on- campus with an optional biochemical engineering concentration. The program has 259 students and produced 66 graduates in the 2019-20 academic year. The program is supported by 15 faculty members and five professional staff.

PROGRAM STRENGTH

The program maintains a strong focus on serving the undergraduate students through multiple opportunities for interaction with the faculty outside of classes and industry representatives on research and professional development. The program has shown its responsiveness to market demand by developing additional concentrations in polymers and molecular engineering, energy and environment, nanotechnology, process automation and entrepreneurship. These opportunities enhance the career readiness of the graduates.

No deficiencies, weaknesses, or concerns were found.